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Dear Prof. Akira S Mori,

We would like to begin by thanking both you and the two anonymous reviewers for your creative and valuable thoughts. On behalf of myself and my coauthors, we appreciate your time and contributions.

All reviewers provided carefully considered comments and we have done our best to accommodate those suggestions here. The most significant changes include a clearly stated and testable hypothesis in the introduction, clearer definition of generalism/specialization, and an extensive niche modelling exercise to test our hypothesis. We believe these additions substantially improve our argument and the quality of the manuscript.

Below please find **reviewer comments in green**, and our responses in black. New text added to the manuscript is **highlighted**. We have formatted a page break between each reviewer. Where necessary, we have interjected our responses among reviewer comments.

On behalf of myself and coauthors, we thank you for your time and consideration,

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